2008 Honda Accord DX

$2,000 · 200,000 miles · Private seller · Ridgecrest, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/4377425409058398/

Report generated October 29, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder







Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$2,353	**$389**	**Good**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	4/5 · 9 recalls · 1,521 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$2,000.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$185.00
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$13.00
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$32.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$2,353.00
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$2,353.00
Amount financed	$0.00
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$2,503.00

Paid in full with your down payment — no loan needed.

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$0.00
Insurance (estimate, liability)	$70.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 25 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$190.00
Maintenance & repair reserve	$115.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$13.58
Total per month	$388.58

Running costs without the loan: **$389/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$7,166** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **liability coverage** estimate ($70/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Good (4/5)

The 2008 Accord's 2.4L 4-cylinder and 5-speed automatic are very durable; at 200k it's about how it was maintained.

NHTSA data for this model year: 9 recalls · 1,521 owner complaints (62 involving a crash). Most complaints: Service Brakes (574), Hydraulic (451), Air Bags (379), Engine (210), Exterior Lighting (113), Electrical System (105).

Known issues for this model

• Oil consumption on some 2008-2012 2.4L engines

• VTC actuator rattle on cold start

• Rear brakes wear fast

• A/C compressor

Check on this car before buying

• Oil level/consumption

• Rattle on cold start

• Wheel studs/hub on the damaged wheel (and that the other wheels are torqued right)

• Smooth shifts

• Seller provides smog certificate

Notes

IN-TOWN CAR (~$3k, for getting to and from work in Ridgecrest; not a DoorDash pick).

$2,000 FIRM or trade, ~200k mi, 4-cyl VTEC automatic, grey/black. CLEAN TITLE IN HAND, 2 owners, paid off. Listed 2026-10-28.

NOT DRIVABLE AS-IS: 3 lug nuts/studs broke off on the passenger side. Cheap fix (~$50-150 for studs + nuts) - do it on the spot with a mobile mechanic or tow it. Seller needs it gone ASAP.

Best value of the in-town options. Check the oil level: the 2.4L can burn oil at high miles.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.